

Case Study

Tallaght Hospital gains significant savings each year with Quadient Impress and folder inserters

Challenge

Tallaght Hospital manages a large operation with a very complex mail flow that spans a diverse range of documents moving through a vast network of stakeholders. They sought to streamline their mail and document processes that would improve the way that the clerical teams in the hospital print, pack, and dispatch their mail items.

Solution

Quadient's [DS-75i folder inserter](#) and powerful document output management software, [Quadient Impress](#), helped Tallaght Hospital establish a centralised mail function.

Results

Quadient's hardware and software combination has given Tallaght Hospital substantial benefits and savings each year:

- Better manage their mail flow
- Saving 40 man hours per week
- Better postal discounts, averaging 10 cents per item by deferring delivery
- Lowering print costs by suppressing unwanted prints from mainframe systems and re-routing internal communications from print to PDF
- Grouping multiple letters going to the same GP for further savings
- Quicker dispatch of mail items

Tallaght Hospital continues to work in partnership with Quadient to find new applications and solutions, which is likely to grow savings even further in the future.



Making sense of a complex mail operation

Tallaght Hospital is one of the biggest healthcare facilities in Ireland. With more than 625 beds and almost 3,000 employees, the hospital provides local, regional, supra-regional and national specialty health services to a massively-growing, urbanised area with a predominantly young population.

As you can imagine, such a large operation makes for a very complex mail flow. With a very diverse range of documents and correspondence moving between patients, medical teams, GPs, admin staff, suppliers, and a vast network of other stakeholders across the wider medical landscape, that equates to a lot of letters going into envelopes.

In 2014, Tallaght Hospital embarked on a project aimed at bringing greater efficiency to this massively complex mail flow.

Saving through centralisation

The overall aim of the project was to reduce costs and save time for employees across the hospital by rationalising and centralising some of the more inefficient and time-consuming mail processes that were being used across the various departments.

Owen Kelleher, Mailroom Manager at Tallaght Hospital, shared some of the challenges that the project aimed to address:



“ We didn’t have a centralised mailroom so all the departments were generating the letters themselves, hand-folding them into envelopes and then physically bringing them to the post room. It was a very inefficient use of staff time. Individual departments were responsible for their own mail and we weren’t availing of postal discounts.”

**- Owen Kelleher,
Mailroom Manager at Tallaght Hospital**



Picking the perfect partner and solution

After a very rigorous tendering and selection process, Brendan Carr, Director of Information Services at Tallaght Hospital, made the decision to partner with Quadient in order to provide a state-of-the-art hardware and software solution that was vital to the success of this important project.

Tallaght Hospital chose to install a DS-75i folder inserter in their new centralised mailroom. This folding and inserting solution offers the perfect blend of productivity, versatility and convenience. It helped Tallaght Hospital eliminate the costly and time-consuming task of manually folding mail items and packing them into envelopes.

Owen shared how the DS-75i transformed their mail preparation processes:

“The benefits to the hospital are huge. The DS-75i allows clerical staff to spend more time on other tasks such as clearing backlogs. We have also made massive savings, and this is just the beginning. As the awareness of the machine has increased around the hospital, we’ve investigated some of the other capabilities of the DS-75i, such as inserting business reply envelopes and leaflets in the area of appointment validation. The DS-75i is robust enough to cope with those applications. We are continually finding new potential uses for it and the machine has been able to comfortably cope with any projects thus far.”

- Owen Kelleher,
Mailroom Manager at Tallaght Hospital



Maximising efficiency with intelligent document output management software

While the versatility of the DS-75i has played a major part, the real driving force behind the success of this project at Tallaght Hospital has been the adoption and implementation of Quadient Impress. This document output management software has transformed the way that mail documents are produced, printed, and posted.

Working with the IT department in Tallaght Hospital, Quadient deployed a site-wide solution that allows users across the hospital to create documents using pre-formatted templates and push them into a centralised print queue.

The software applies OMR marks for intelligent packing and groups multiple documents that are going to the same recipient — helping to reduce the number of envelopes that would have been used and saving on postage costs.

The system also distinguishes between internal and external communications, suppressing the print of internal documents and making them available via PDF instead. This reduces the volume of paper being used and keeps print costs down.

This has had a major impact on efficiency across the various clerical departments throughout the hospital; transforming the way in which outbound mail pieces are produced, printed, and packed. Letters and documents can now be created digitally in the various offices across the hospital. They are then pushed to the new mailroom for printing, packing, and dispatching. This has led to massive savings in terms of man hours, print costs, and postage expenses.





Reaping the rewards

Rita Ray heads up the various clerical teams within the perioperative directorate, one of three such directorates in the hospital. Rita and her teams are responsible for managing a huge array of correspondence relating to patients undergoing surgery at the hospital. Rita describes how things were before the new system was adopted:



“The letters were printed and would just sit in piles and piles until someone had time to spend a half day during the week folding hundreds of letters. If that person wasn’t available, then we would just wait and some of the letters could have sat around for 2 to 3 weeks. There was also significant cost involved as we weren’t grouping the letters... the GPs were getting 10 letters a day from 3 different areas.”

- Rita Ray,
Head of Perioperative Directorate at Tallaght Hospital

With the new centralised system in place, things are very different for Rita and her teams.

“What we’re getting from the system so far is fantastic. It’s saving a lot of man hours. We also have 50% deferred post now so we avail of the cheaper postage rates. The average saving is about 10 cents per letter, which is considerable. In addition, in terms of the man hours saved by the new system, a safe estimate would be about 40 hours per week. It’s fantastic.”

- Rita Ray,
Head of Perioperative Directorate at Tallaght Hospital



With savings of 40 hours every week and an average of 10 cents on every piece of deferred mail, the savings quickly stack up. When you factor in the additional economies achieved by minimising print volumes, envelope costs, and postage expenditure, and by grouping items for the same recipient, it's easy to see how this new system is saving Tallaght Hospital considerable expenditure each year. And this is just the beginning...

The power of a partnership approach

Quadiant understands that a project like this doesn't achieve success based solely on the choice of equipment. Having the right hardware and software is very important but it doesn't guarantee success. When embarking on a major efficiency drive, it's important to pick a partner who will work with you to understand your operation. You need someone who will tailor the solution to your exact requirements and work in long-term partnership with you to provide ongoing service, support, and fresh ideas on how to make further improvements. Owen Kelleher agrees. When asked if he would recommend Quadiant:

“Absolutely. It has been a great experience for us. The local support that Quadiant provides is very good indeed!”

- Owen Kelleher,
Mailroom Manager at Tallaght Hospital

